AUTONOMOUS REGION FOR NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

AR4NA Business Meeting Minutes

September 1, 2026

6:00 PM Pacific / 9:00 PM Eastern | Zoom

Members Present

Bill Fritz, Patrick Burns, Jon Arrigo, Jim Dugan, Danette Banyai, Alan Heisinger, Allen Jackson, Ann Premazon, and Jacob Butki.

1. Introductions

The meeting opened with introductions. Members shared their names, clean dates, and brief histories of their involvement in Narcotics Anonymous and service.

Discussion during introductions included experience with group, area, regional, H&I, literature, and world-level service, as well as previous involvement with ARNA and related service efforts. Members expressed a common interest in group autonomy and in developing a service structure that remains directly accountable to the groups it serves.

2. History of AR4NA: Pennsylvania and California

The group reviewed the history of ARNA and the establishment of the Autonomous Region for Narcotics Anonymous (AR4NA).

AR4NA was incorporated in Pennsylvania on November 1, 2022.

The former California corporation, ARNA, was terminated on April 2, 2026.

It was emphasized that ARNA and AR4NA are separate organizations. With the California corporation now closed, AR4NA is moving forward as a Pennsylvania organization with a separate legal foundation and an opportunity to determine its purpose and direction.

The reasoning behind establishing AR4NA in Pennsylvania was also reviewed. Previous litigation involving Dave Moorhead occurred in Pennsylvania, and those involved in establishing AR4NA believed Pennsylvania provided a more appropriate legal footing should AR4NA ever face litigation in the future.

At the same time, the group emphasized that AR4NA has no desire to initiate litigation with NA World Services. The purpose of AR4NA is to serve addicts and groups, not to organize around conflict with NAWS.

3. Who We Are / Current Board of Directors

The current Board of Directors was identified as:

- Patrick Burns - President/CEO
- Bill Fritz - Secretary
- Allen Jackson - Treasurer
- Jon Arrigo - Board Member

The board was established as part of the legal requirements for maintaining the Pennsylvania corporation. Discussion distinguished the legal responsibilities of the corporate board from the Fellowship and service functions of AR4NA. The board exists to handle necessary corporate matters and is not intended to govern or direct NA groups.

The group also reviewed the principles developed through previous ARNA workshops:

- AR4NA has no desire to litigate with NA World Services.
- NA can function as a worldwide Fellowship without requiring a publishing corporation or Board of Directors to govern the Fellowship.
- AR4NA follows Tradition Nine. Service boards or committees may be created when needed, but they have no authority to rule, censor, dictate, or decide for the Fellowship.

The stated purpose remains to help the addict, serve groups and meetings, and support one another spiritually, physically, mentally, and emotionally. These ideas remain open to continued discussion and refinement as AR4NA develops.

4. Continuation of the Board of Directors

For Pennsylvania reporting purposes, a brief formal board meeting was conducted during the larger AR4NA meeting.

Motion	Allen Jackson moved that AR4NA continue operating into 2027 with the current Board of Directors.
Second	Bill Fritz seconded the motion.
Vote	The current board members voted in favor.
Result	**Motion passed unanimously.**
Statement	**AR4NA plans to continue operations in 2027 with the same Board of Directors serving during 2026.**

The formal board portion of the meeting was then concluded and the general AR4NA meeting resumed.

5. Are We Ready to Be Public-Facing?

The group discussed whether AR4NA is ready to establish a more visible public presence. There was support for creating an AR4NA website, but members discussed the importance of being able to clearly explain who AR4NA is, what AR4NA does, how AR4NA serves groups and addicts, how groups and members can become involved, and what resources AR4NA will provide.

Members expressed concern about creating a website that functions only as a static landing page. The goal would be to create something useful and interactive for members and groups.

No final decision was made regarding a full public launch.

6. Website and Member Interaction

Possible website functions discussed included:

- AR4NA's purpose and mission
- Supporting groups and meetings
- Information about upcoming AR4NA meetings
- Ways for groups to submit meeting information
- Downloadable recovery literature and service resources
- NA historical material
- Member-written articles and submissions
- Information about inexpensive printed literature

Ann discussed the possibility of incorporating or connecting AR4NA with NA History Tree, which already contains a substantial collection of historical NA documents and downloadable material.

Members emphasized that communication will be essential if AR4NA is going to grow beyond those already participating. The group will continue considering whether a basic public website should be launched now or whether additional structure should first be developed.

7. AR4NA Internet Domains

Ann reported that AR4NA-related internet domains had been secured, including AR4NA.com and AR4NA.org, along with domains using the full Autonomous Region for Narcotics Anonymous name.

Ann offered to transfer the domains to AR4NA, and the board agreed to accept the transfer.

Details concerning ownership, registration, renewals, and future expenses will be handled separately.

8. Staying Focused on AR4NA

The group discussed the agenda item concerning how to avoid becoming consumed by NAWS-related discussions and instead focus on who we are, what we do, and how we do it.

Members acknowledged that many participants have considerable history and strong opinions concerning NA World Services. There was also recognition that AR4NA needs to establish an identity based on what it can positively provide to addicts and groups rather than defining itself primarily through opposition to another service body.

The discussion centered on service, group autonomy, communication, accessibility, and practical resources.

9. Inexpensive NA Literature

The group discussed whether AR4NA should participate in making inexpensive NA literature available.

Jon described an existing independent literature network with established printing files, inventory, distribution capabilities, and funding. He reported that approximately 25,000 books are currently being distributed every three months.

Discussion included Fifth Edition Basic Texts, Grey Books, possible Sixth Edition printing, H&I literature, and providing literature at or near production cost.

There was substantial interest in making inexpensive literature available to addicts, groups, H&I efforts, jails, prisons, and other places where literature is needed.

At the same time, members cautioned against allowing AR4NA to become primarily a publishing or book-selling organization. Literature could be one service AR4NA provides, but should not become its entire identity or purpose.

No formal decision was made to establish an AR4NA literature operation.

10. Printed and Digital Literature

The discussion expanded to include digital literature and other electronic resources.

- Free downloadable recovery literature
- Literature accessible by phones and tablets
- QR codes directing members to online resources
- Digital access for incarcerated addicts
- Downloadable service materials
- Maintaining inexpensive printed literature where physical books are needed

Members recognized that printed books remain important, particularly for H&I and for members who prefer physical literature, while electronic resources are becoming increasingly useful and accessible. There was interest in making both formats available wherever practical.

11. How AR4NA Can Grow

The group discussed ways AR4NA could grow while avoiding the development of another large centralized service bureaucracy.

- Direct support for autonomous groups
- H&I and PR/PI resources
- Literature resources
- Historical archives
- Sharing experience between groups
- Online resources
- Social media and improved internet visibility
- Encouraging direct group participation

Members discussed AR4NA functioning primarily as an informational and support structure that groups can voluntarily use. No final service structure was adopted.

12. Member Communication and Publications

Jim raised the possibility of AR4NA providing an independent publication or online platform where NA members could share their experiences and viewpoints.

Possible content included recovery articles, experience, strength and hope, group experience, service-related discussions, current issues affecting NA, historical material, and member-created recovery writing.

Ann noted that an interactive website could include forms allowing members to submit material directly. The discussion emphasized that simply creating a website will not be enough; AR4NA will also need to actively communicate so members and groups know the resources exist.

13. Items for Continued Discussion

- Who AR4NA is

- AR4NA's mission and purpose
- The relationship between the Board of Directors and AR4NA's service functions
- Whether AR4NA is ready to become public-facing
- Website development and member interaction
- How AR4NA can grow
- Literature printing and distribution
- Digital literature and resources
- Group participation
- Member communications and publications
- Developing enough structure for accountability without creating unnecessary bureaucracy

14. Next Meeting

The group agreed to meet again in approximately two weeks, around September 15, 2026.

Jim specifically suggested continuing the discussion concerning the pros and cons of making the AR4NA website public before the organization's structure is fully developed.

Closing

The meeting concluded with the Serenity Prayer.

Minutes prepared by:
Jacob Butki